Production Change and Release Process

Document Owner: Engineering Operations
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Applies To: All production services

1. Purpose

This process defines how engineering teams plan, approve, test, and deploy changes to production services. It supports the Technology Change Management Standard.

2. Scope

Covers application releases, infrastructure changes, and configuration changes to any production environment.

3. Change Approval

3.1 Every production change must be approved in the change record before it is deployed. Deployment pipelines reject any change without a recorded approval.

3.2 The approver must be a different person from the engineer who implemented the change. The pipeline blocks self-approval automatically.

3.3 The change record captures the approver name and the approval timestamp when approval is granted.

4. Testing

4.1 Every change is deployed to the staging environment and verified there before a production release is scheduled.

5. Rollback

5.1 Engineers discuss a rollback approach during the release readiness call.

6. Emergency Changes

6.1 Emergency changes may be deployed immediately without prior approval at the discretion of the on-call engineer. No retrospective review is required.

7. Records

7.1 Deployment records are retained in the pipeline audit log.